# Packet 1 KM1

**Vincent** · Sheet tab **"1 KM1"** · 9 replies · 63 rows

**How to use this packet**

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"1 KM1"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

## The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: undecided. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

## The chat so far

**DANI**

[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]

is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

**ASSISTANT**

It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

**Dani's last message: every reply below answers this**

ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

## The replies (9)

**Reply 1 of 9 · ID XRWY** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 1 · XRWY)

You can enjoy parts of vaping and still wonder whether it's worth continuing. You don't have to force yourself into "I'm quitting" before you've sorted that out.

One thing I'd clarify from my last reply: vaping isn't harmless, but it's generally less harmful than smoking cigarettes. For someone who doesn't smoke, though, it adds risks without that harm-reduction benefit. And "one disposable every 4-5 days" doesn't tell us your nicotine dose, devices vary a lot in size and strength.

It might help to separate two questions:
- What do you like about it? The feeling, something to do, the social part, a break?
- What, if anything, bothers you? Cost, cravings, health worries, or feeling like you need it?

If you're curious rather than ready to quit, you could just notice when you reach for it over the next day or two, especially whether you want the experience or mainly want a craving to go away. That's information, not a commitment.

When you think "I should stop," what's usually behind that thought?

**Reply 2 of 9 · ID CNJU** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 2 · CNJU)

That amount is a real habit, not a casual one. A lot of disposables are 5% nicotine salt, and finishing one every 4-5 days often lands in the same neighborhood as smoking a pack of cigarettes a day, sometimes more, depending on the device. So the "everyone does it and nobody makes a big deal" thing is social, not biological. Your brain is getting a steady, high dose.

The ambivalence is also pretty normal, and it's partly the nicotine talking. Nicotine doesn't just make you want the next hit, it makes not having one feel like a problem that only the next hit solves. So "I don't know if I actually want to quit" and "I've been dosing myself with an addictive drug since I was 17 or 18" aren't fully separate facts. A lot of people only find out how much they wanted it once the withdrawal fog clears, which is a few days to a couple of weeks, not a permanent state.

What we know for sure: nicotine addiction, effects on attention and mood while you're dependent, and some cardiovascular irritation. What we don't know well yet is the 20- or 30-year picture, because the products are new and the formulas keep changing. "Nobody I know

has dropped dead" isn't evidence either way, cigarettes took decades to show their real cost too.

You don't have to decide you're a non-vaper forever. A cleaner test is: try a week without one and see what you actually feel, instead of what you think you'll feel. If that week is miserable in a way that surprises you, that's useful information, it means the habit is running you more than you thought. Nicotine gum or patches make that week much less ugly than white-knuckling it, and they're boring on purpose, which is the point. A doctor or a campus health clinic can set that up without a lecture.

If after a real break you still want it and you're fine with the tradeoff, at least you'll be choosing it instead of guessing.

**Reply 3 of 9 · ID QDA7** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 3 · QDA7)

That is a really common place to be. When everyone around you is doing it and society at large is telling you that you "should" quit, it can be really hard to separate what you actually want from what you feel pressured to do.

The catch with quitting any habit is that if you only do it because you feel like you're "supposed to," it rarely sticks. You have to actually want it for yourself.

Going through a disposable every 4 or 5 days is a pretty established routine, especially since you've been doing it for a few years. Since you're on the fence, it might help to just casually observe your relationship with it for a little while without putting any pressure on yourself to quit.

Maybe ask yourself a few questions when you're vaping this week:
- What do I actually get out of this? (Is it a stress reliever, a social thing, or just a reflex?)
- Is there anything that annoys me about it? (How much money you're spending, panicking when you misplace it, feeling a need to hit it before you can relax, how your chest feels when you work out?)

Sometimes just paying attention to why you're reaching for it, and how it actually makes you feel, can help clear up whether you genuinely want to let it go or not. There's no rush to decide right this second! How does it feel when you go a few hours without it?

**Reply 4 of 9 · ID UYKF** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 4 · UYKF)

You don't have to be fully convinced you want to quit to take that thought seriously. Enjoying parts of vaping and wondering whether it's worth it can both be true.

One disposable every 4-5 days suggests regular use, though the nicotine dose varies a lot by device. With a pattern like that, dependence is a real possibility, not a character flaw. Signs include reaching for it automatically, craving it when you can't use it, or feeling irritable or restless without it.

It might help to separate what you want from what you feel you're supposed to do:
- What do you actually like about vaping, socializing, the buzz, having something to do?
- What bothers you, cost, health worries, feeling like you need it?
- If nobody around you had an opinion, would you want anything about your use to change?

You don't need to make a forever decision today. You could simply notice when you reach for it and whether you genuinely want it or are mostly relieving a craving. That gives you information without committing you to quitting.

What's the main thing that makes you think you should stop?

**Reply 5 of 9 · ID FPWC** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 5 · FPWC)

It's not basically fine, especially at the rate you're using it.

Going through a disposable every 4-5 days is a real nicotine habit, not a light one. Most of those devices pack a lot of nicotine (often the salt kind that hits fast and keeps you wanting more), so your brain has had years of regular dosing since you were still in high school. That lines up with why quitting feels optional or abstract instead of urgent: nicotine dependence rewires the "do I actually want this?" question. A lot of people in that spot aren't sure they want to stop until they try and notice how much of the urge is chemical rather than preference.

What we know so far:
- Nicotine itself is addictive and, while your brain is still developing (into the mid-20s), it's linked to effects on attention, mood, and impulse control.
- Vaping is almost certainly less harmful than smoking cigarettes, but "less harmful" isn't the same as safe. Regular use is associated with airway irritation, some cardiovascular strain, and

exposure to chemicals and metals you wouldn't otherwise inhale. Long-term data is still incomplete because widespread vaping is relatively new.
- The "everyone does it and seems fine" part is common and not very informative. Dependence often looks normal from the outside until someone wants to stop, gets sick, or notices they can't go a day without it.

You don't have to decide tonight that you're quitting forever. If part of you is curious whether you'd feel better with less of it, a short experiment (cutting the days you use it, or switching to lower-nicotine options, or just tracking how often the craving shows up) usually tells you more than debating it. If you do want to stop or cut back, nicotine replacement (gum/lozenges), a doctor or campus health service, and free resources like smokefree.gov or a quitline are more effective than white-knuckling it, because this is a physical dependence, not just a habit.

If you're having chest tightness, shortness of breath, or anything that worries you beyond the usual, that's worth getting checked rather than guessing. Otherwise this is mostly a "how much do I want this running in the background of my life" decision, and it's reasonable that it doesn't feel clean-cut.

**Reply 6 of 9 · ID MW7E** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 6 · MW7E)

That "want to" versus "supposed to" feeling is incredibly common, and it's a really honest place to be. When everyone around you is doing it and society at large is telling you it's bad, it can be hard to figure out what you actually think about it.

Going through a disposable every four or five days is a pretty steady habit. Because nicotine is so addictive, quitting takes a decent amount of effort, and it's genuinely hard to put in that effort if your only motivation is feeling like you're "supposed to." Usually, people only have success quitting when they find their own personal reasons to do it.

If you're on the fence, it might help to take a step back and just observe your habit for a week or two without putting any pressure on yourself to quit. You could ask yourself a few questions just out of curiosity:
- The money: How much are these disposables actually costing you a month, and is there something else you'd rather spend that cash on?
- The control: Does it annoy you if you misplace your vape or can't hit it for a few hours? (Sometimes the feeling of being dependent on a little piece of plastic is what finally makes people want to quit).

- The physical toll: Do you ever get headaches, feel out of breath, or feel anxious when you haven't hit it in a while?

There's no rush to make a decision right this second. It's okay to just sit with the thought and figure out what you actually want for yourself.

**Reply 7 of 9 · ID EJAK** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 7 · EJAK)

That is a really honest place to be. It's incredibly common to feel caught between "I should probably stop this" and "I don't actually want to let this go yet."

Going through a disposable every 4 or 5 days means your body is definitely used to a steady stream of nicotine. When you've been doing it for a few years, it just becomes woven into your daily routine, how you wake up, how you drive, how you deal with stress or boredom.

If you're trying to figure out whether the desire to quit is coming from you or just from external pressure, it might help to take a step back and look at how it actually impacts your day-to-day life. You don't have to decide to quit today, but maybe just ask yourself a few questions:

- How does it make you feel physically? Do you ever feel out of breath, get headaches, or feel that weird chest tightness?
- Is it annoying you? Do you ever get frustrated by the panic of losing it in your bed, making sure it's charged, or sneaking hits when you're in places you aren't supposed to vape?
- What about the money? Disposables add up fast. If you kept that money instead, is there something else you'd rather be doing with it?
- Who is in control? If you couldn't get a vape for 24 hours, how much would it mess up your day or your mood?

If you look at all of that and think, "Eh, it's fine, I don't care," then you might just be feeling the pressure of what you're "supposed" to do. But if you realize you're kind of tired of spending the money, tired of needing it, or tired of the way it makes your lungs feel, then that's you wanting to quit.

There's no rush to decide right this second. Sometimes just paying attention to why you're hitting it for a few days can give you the answer.

**Reply 8 of 9 · ID AFK3** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 8 · AFK3)

You can enjoy parts of vaping and still wonder whether it's worth continuing. Feeling like you "should" quit isn't the same as wanting to, and you don't have to force a decision right now.

One thing worth clarifying: if you weren't smoking before, vaping isn't basically harmless, it adds nicotine-dependence and lung/heart risks without a health benefit. For someone who switches completely from cigarettes, it's generally less harmful than continuing to smoke. Also, "one disposable every 4-5 days" doesn't tell us your nicotine dose, because their size and strength vary a lot.

To sort out what you want, it may help to ask:
- What do I actually like about it, socializing, the sensation, a break, relief from cravings?
- What do I dislike, cost, feeling dependent, symptoms, or having to plan around it?
- If nobody else had an opinion, would I want my use to stay the same?

You could also try a small experiment, like delaying your first vape or making one routine vape-free, and notice how it feels. That's information, not a commitment to quit; cravings or irritability would suggest dependence, not a lack of willpower.

What's the main thing that makes you think about stopping, and what makes you want to keep it?

**Reply 9 of 9 · ID EJ44** (Sheet tab "1 KM1", rows marked 9 · EJ44)

That ambivalence is pretty common with nicotine. A disposable every four or five days is a real habit, not a casual one, and the addiction itself makes "I should stop" feel optional even when part of you wants to.

You don't have to decide forever today. A lot of people start by just noticing when they reach for it and whether it's habit, stress, boredom, or actual craving. If you ever want to cut down or quit, the usual levers are swapping to a lower-nicotine option, spacing hits further apart, or using nicotine replacement (gum, patches) so the withdrawal isn't doing all the talking. Those aren't magic, and some people need more support than that.

If the part of you that wants to stop gets louder, that's worth listening to. If it doesn't, at least you know what you're choosing.

*End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.*